

Giving your projects a memory.

With busy days for each of us, you may find that parts of your AI-involved work start to drift, or produce gaffes, as chats, iterations and your ideas move along. The bots hallucinate: 'tis how it is. Follow this guide to learn how to manage your projects, and give them a bit of a memory.

You'll need

- ✓ **Claude Code**, signed in claude.com ↗
- ✓ **Obsidian**, free, to read your vault obsidian.md ↗
- ✓ a **Mac** or a **Windows** PC
- ✓ **Python**, used behind the scenes. Setup checks it for you
- ✓ about **10 minutes**, once

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You do not have to live in a terminal

Claude Code comes in more than one shape: a **desktop app** for Mac and Windows, a command in a terminal, a tab in your browser, and an extension inside editors like VS Code. **adjutant works the same in all of them**: identical commands, identical vault. The desktop app is the gentlest place to start, and nothing in this guide needs a terminal until the optional toolkit at the very end.

A vault is your project's memory.

When a project spans days, your decisions, your thinking, your whole sense of what you're even doing can erode, drift off, or cease to exist altogether. If that weren't bad enough, imagine being a sycophantic robot going through the same thing. *L'horreur*.

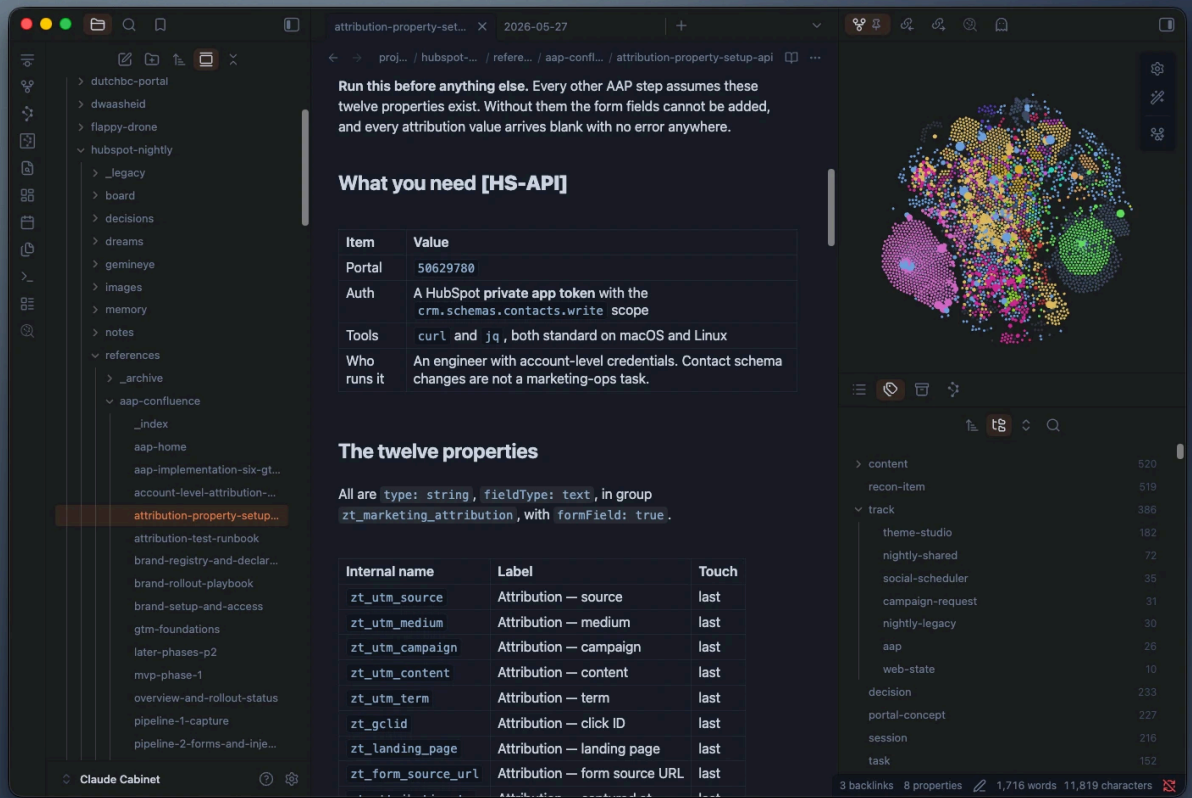
To keep things from dissipating out of memory, or scrolling out of view forever, the **vault** offers some relief: it keeps an AI workspace organised.

A vault, read in **Obsidian** (though any tidy folder of text files works), does a few things for the AI you work with:

- gives the AI a dedicated place to keep memories, notes, and iterations
- holds it to a bit of digital hygiene
 - fewer hallucinations, more accurate statements and assertions
 - far easier to read when you review it by hand
- interlinks data, notes, and information (à la wikilinks)
- keeps a persistent memory of how the project grew
- lets you pick up cold: a new chat can be caught up in one message
 - no re-explaining the project from scratch every Monday
- settles arguments with your past self: the decision and its reasoning sit in writing
- keeps the receipts when someone asks why a thing was built that way
- costs you less: a short, pointed catch-up beats re-pasting half a project
 - fewer tokens burned re-establishing what the AI should already know
- it is just folders and text files: yours, readable without us, portable anywhere

◆ ★ SLOP PATTERNS: THRIVING EVICTED ★ ◆

~~"Certainly!" ~ "A load-bearing idea!" ~ "You're absolutely right!"~~



A vault in Obsidian: your projects down the left, the note you are reading in the middle, and how everything links together on the right.

What lives in a vault?

Files and folders. Folders and files. That's it. In terms of what they're *for*:

Sessions Automatic notes of what you did, per day	Decisions The choices made, and why
Handoff Where things stand, for next time	Board A JIRA-like board, but less annoying. Kanban-style

How it fits together



And it reads back when you ask `sitrepro` or `check`.

What a connected project looks like

Claude Vault/

└ projects/

└ my-app/

└─ brief.md

the project's purpose

└─ sessions/

one note per working day

└─ decisions/

why you chose things

└─ tasks/

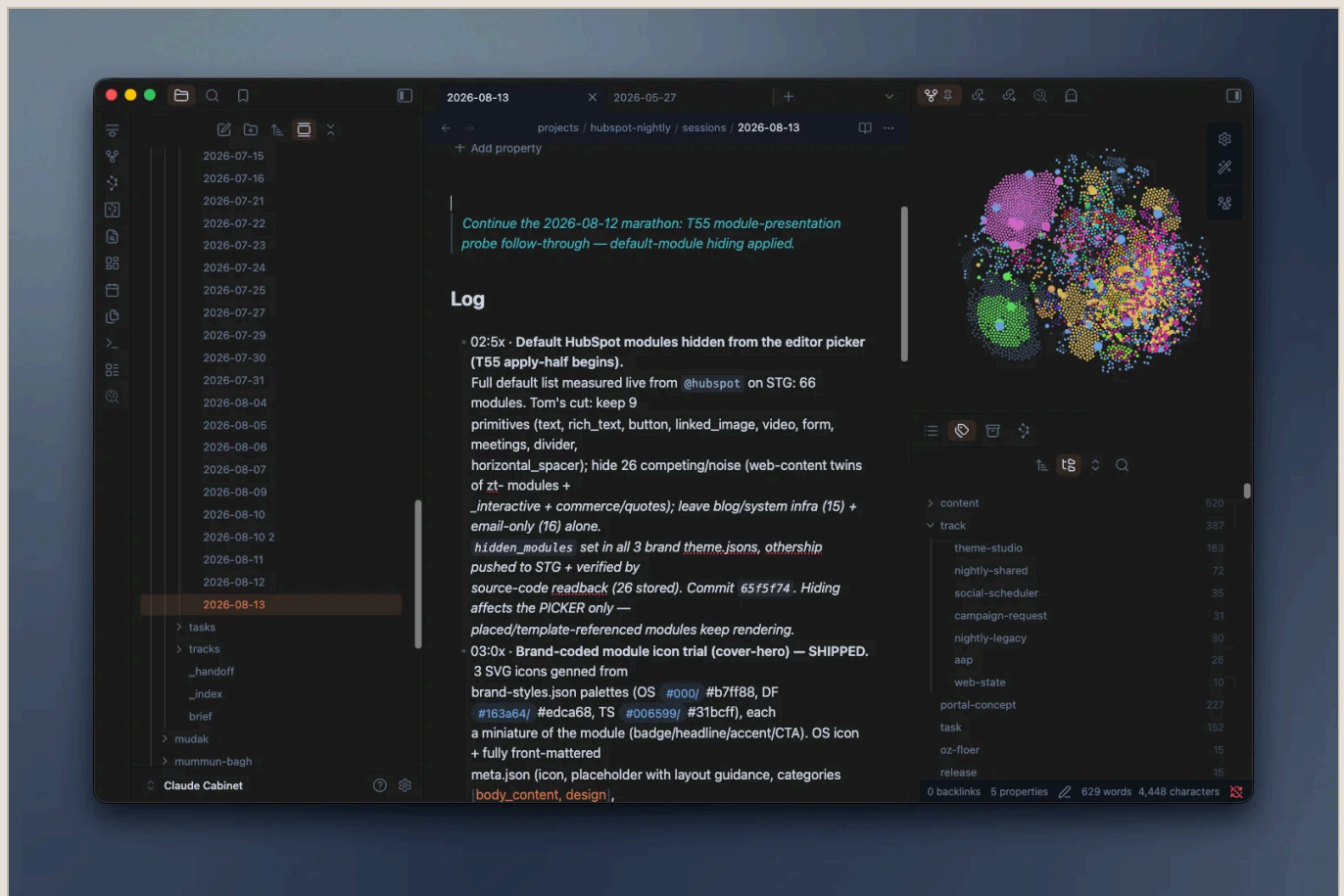
→ becomes the board

└─ board/

the kanban, saved to disk

└─ _handoff.md

where things stand



A session note: one per working day, written as you go. The days stack up on the left, so last month is still there when you need it.

Adjutant keeps it fresh. You just work. Mainly.

The adjutant is a spin-off from a personal framework I've built up working with the bane of my existence: AI. So far I've found it mostly reliable. As with any AI plug-in, how well it serves you tracks your own willingness to catch it misbehaving as you go.

That said, it makes two things easier: directing what the AI does, and bringing a touch of systems thinking to how you work.

Happens on its own ■ Session notes ■ The handoff, kept current ■ The board, built from your in-chat task lists ■ Every write checked against a standard shape	What you must do ■ Connect it once per project ■ Run sitrep when you're back, or starting a new chat ■ Remind the chat to use the adjutant to capture insight and progress ■ Run tidy to clear the machine dust
--	--

The adjutant has seven verbs

Verbs are commands you drop into a chat message. Type one and it triggers that adjutant feature.

connect	Link a project to its vault
sync	Push current state to the vault
check	Health report READ ONLY
sitrep	“Where was I?” after a break READ ONLY
tidy	Safe cleanup, previews first
dream	Advisory review READ ONLY
board	Drag-and-drop kanban

```
⌵ %4  * Run adjutant commands for screenshots

| Successfully loaded skill

Searched for 3 patterns, read 2 files, ran 1 shell command

• Now running sitrep.py with the project root and vault path.

Ran 1 shell command

• cost: ~692k tokens, 605 files

🔴🟢 Where we are - HubSpot Nightly; last touched 9h ago, so it's been a bit.
  ▣ What's done - 73 decisions, 62 sessions, 38 notes, 95 tasks, 28 references, 8 dreams; last session
  2026-08-13.
  📁 The vault - /Users/tomvanderhegden/Library/Mobile Documents/iCloud~md~obsidian/Documents/Claude Cabinet
  (304 files).
  🛠 On main at 90d28384 "fix(cover-hero): visibility key, white-on-white forms, icon cache, form_key (T55)",
  tree clean · dev server down
  📋 Suitcase environment on this machine: run suitcase-brief for orientation
  📄 Board: 70 open (1 in motion), stale
  📌 Start here - ONE Y/N pending from Tom: additive correction callout on
  decisions/2026-05-08-consolidation-design.md (housekeeping waiting: run /adjutant tidy).

* Sautéed for 39s

> |

90d2838  main  07h | ~ hubspot-nightly · 🔍 · h:7h! · ▣ 70.1* · 🆕 | Sonnet 5 hi ████████ 8% | -
>> accept edits on (shift+tab to cycle) · ⬅ 1 agent
```

One command after a week away: where you were, what is done, where the vault is, and the next thing to pick up.

On dream, and on cost

dream reads your notes and hands you a report — what's stale, what contradicts, what's orphaned — then **stops**. It changes nothing on its own; you decide. And the whole plugin is built to be light: heavy reads estimate their cost and ask first.


```
ⓧ 4  * Run adjutant commands for screenshots

Type: coding · Status: active · Codename: none
Created: 2026-05-08 · Updated: 2026-08-12

Activity

- Last session: 2026-08-13
- Last decision: 2026-08-12
- Last dream: 2026-08-13
- Handoff: 🟡 9h · NEXT: 1. ONE Y/N pending from Tom: additive correction callout on · STALE
(mirrored 2026-08-13 - not re-synced since)
- Counts: 73 decisions, 62 sessions, 8 dreams, 38 notes
- Board: backlog: 62, next: 7, doing: 1, review: 0, done: 15, icebox: 10 · stale
- Schema: 547 checked, 154 flagged
(64 missing-required, 91 unknown-field, 1 status, 0 type-conflict, 0 epistemic)
- Freshness: 34 declared - 3 dated-unbounded

Drift signal

Unknown item count per dream 2026-08-13

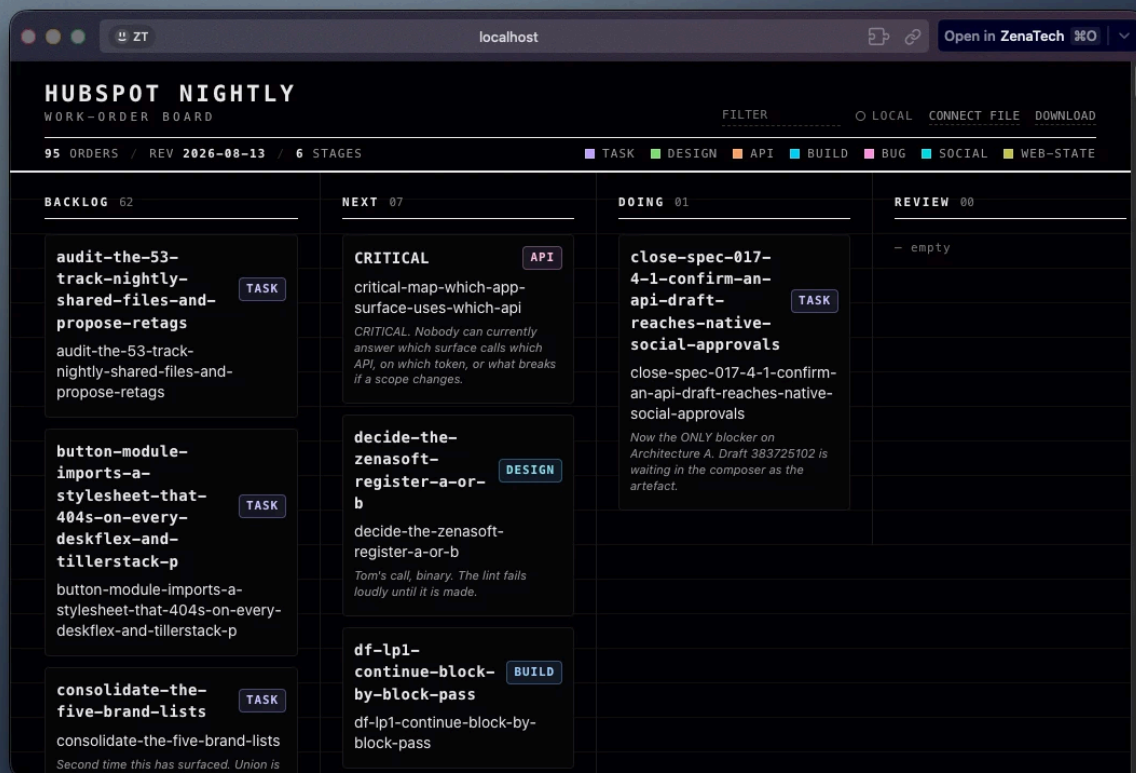
154 files off schema → run /adjutant tidy (strip/migrate after preview)
3 declared facts need review (dated-unbounded) → run /adjutant dream

* Cooked for 19s

>

90d2838  main  ⓧ7h | ~ hubspot-nightly · ⚡ · h:7h! · 🟡 70.1% · ⓧnew | Sonnet 5 hi 🟢 9% | -
>> auto mode on (shift+tab to cycle) · ⓧ 1 agent
```

A health read on the project: recent activity, what the board holds, and anything that has drifted out of shape.



The board, built from your task notes and served on your own machine. Drag a card between columns and the change is saved back to disk.

The words, in plain English.

The next few pages use some words that get thrown around as if everyone was born knowing them. Here they are, once, plainly. Nothing below needs you to understand how any of it works underneath.

Terminal	An app that came with your computer where you type commands instead of clicking. Also called the command line, the shell, or the CLI. Same thing.
GitHub	A website where people keep files and code so others can get at them. Think Dropbox, built for projects.
Repository	One project's folder on GitHub. Everyone says repo . This guide's tools live in one.
Git	The thing underneath that records every change to a project, so you can see what changed and go back. You do not need to learn it for any of this.
Branch	One version of a project's files, running alongside the others. You will see the name of yours in the statusline. Ignore it for now.
Zip	A folder squashed into a single file so it can be downloaded. Double-click it and the folder comes back.
Plugin	An add-on that teaches Claude Code new commands. adjutant is one.
Marketplace	A list of plugins Claude Code can install from. You point it at one, once, and then install from it.
Markdown	Plain text with a few marks for formatting: # starts a heading, - starts a list item. Your notes are markdown files, readable in any text editor, forever.
Python	A programming language. adjutant uses it to do its filing. You never write any and never see it; it only has to be installed.
Homebrew	A way of installing other tools on a Mac in one line, instead of hunting for downloads. Only needed for the optional toolkit at the end.
Shell, Zsh	The part of the terminal that reads what you type. Zsh is the one Macs use. Nothing to choose or configure.
Kanban	Cards in columns: waiting, doing, done. You drag a card across as the work moves. That is the board.

Set it up.

First, install the two free apps this needs: **Claude Code** and **Obsidian**. Downloading Obsidian from obsidian.md works on both a Mac and a PC.

On a Windows PC

The steps below are the same on both systems, with one extra setup on Windows: Claude Code runs inside **WSL**, a Linux-flavoured terminal that ships with Windows. Open **PowerShell**, run `ws1 -install` once, restart, then open **Ubuntu** from the Start menu and do everything there. Your vault can live in **OneDrive** as usual: it gets found either way.

One thing that runs in the background

adjutant does its filing with **Python**, which is already on most machines. You never write any and you never see it: it only has to be present, version **3.9 or newer**. Rather than go looking for it yourself, paste this into Claude Code and let it check.

In Claude Code checks, and tells you how to fix it

```
Do I have Python 3.9 or newer? If not, tell me exactly how to
get it on this machine.
```

On a Mac the answer is usually Apple's own free developer tools, and your computer offers to install them in a window. Inside Ubuntu on Windows it is already there.

Nothing to download for this part, and nothing to sign in to. Each box below has a **Copy** button. Copy it, then paste it where the label says — your Terminal app, or the Claude Code chat. You don't type the box itself.

1

Install the plugin

Paste these into the Claude Code chat, one at a time.

In Claude Code tells it where to find the tool

```
/plugin marketplace add TomVDH/furtive-follies
```

In Claude Code installs adjudant

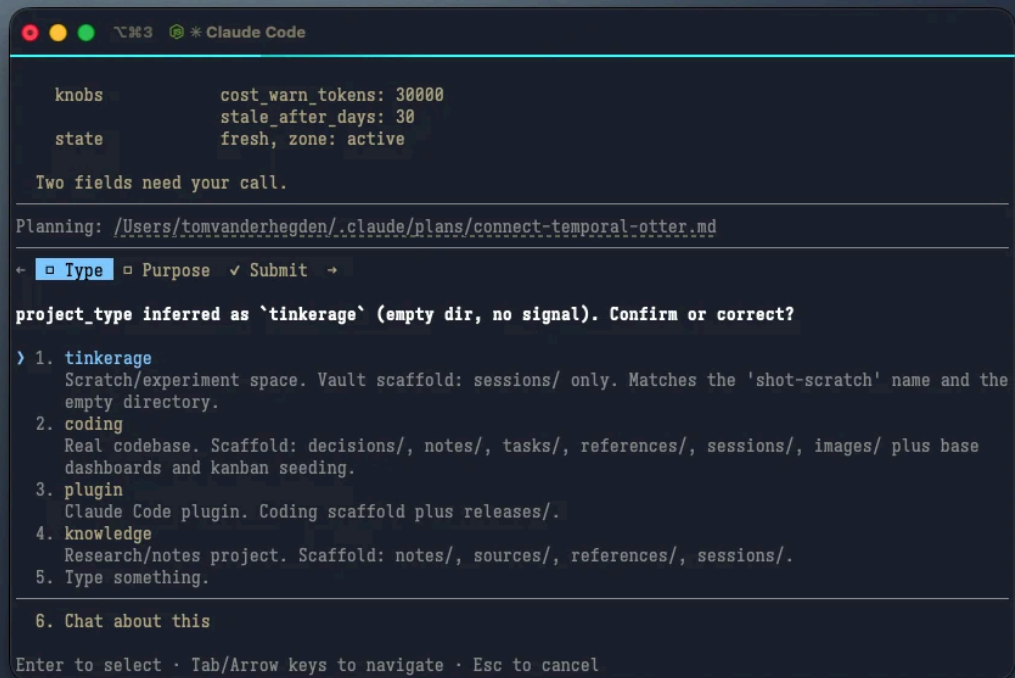
```
/plugin install adjudant
```

Connect your project

Do this once inside each project. It shows where a vault can live, recommends a spot, and makes it for you.

In Claude Code sets up the vault

```
/adjutant connect
```



The screenshot shows the Claude Code application window. At the top, there's a status bar with window controls and the text "Claude Code". Below that, a table displays project configuration:

knobs	cost_warn_tokens: 30000
	stale_after_days: 30
state	fresh, zone: active

Below the table, it says "Two fields need your call." followed by a separator line. Then, it shows the planning path: "Planning: /Users/tomvanderhegden/.claude/plans/connect-temporal-otter.md".

A navigation bar contains: "Type" (selected), "Purpose", and "Submit".

The main content area displays the prompt: "project_type inferred as `tinkering` (empty dir, no signal). Confirm or correct?"

A list of options follows:

1. **tinkering**
Scratch/experiment space. Vault scaffold: sessions/ only. Matches the 'shot-scratch' name and the empty directory.
2. **coding**
Real codebase. Scaffold: decisions/, notes/, tasks/, references/, sessions/, images/ plus base dashboards and kanban seeding.
3. **plugin**
Claude Code plugin. Coding scaffold plus releases/.
4. **knowledge**
Research/notes project. Scaffold: notes/, sources/, references/, sessions/.
5. **Type something.**

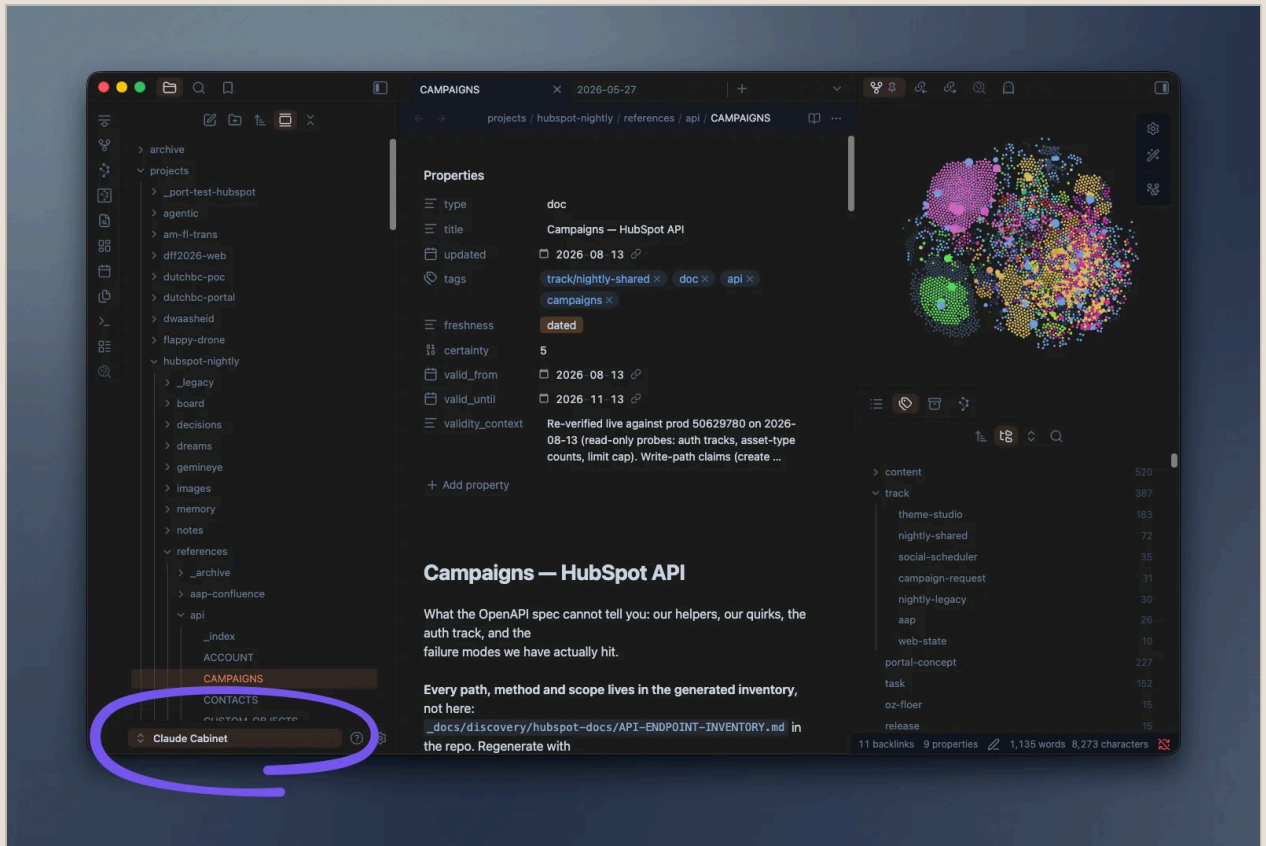
Below the list is option 6: "6. Chat about this".

At the bottom, a footer reads: "Enter to select · Tab/Arrow keys to navigate · Esc to cancel".

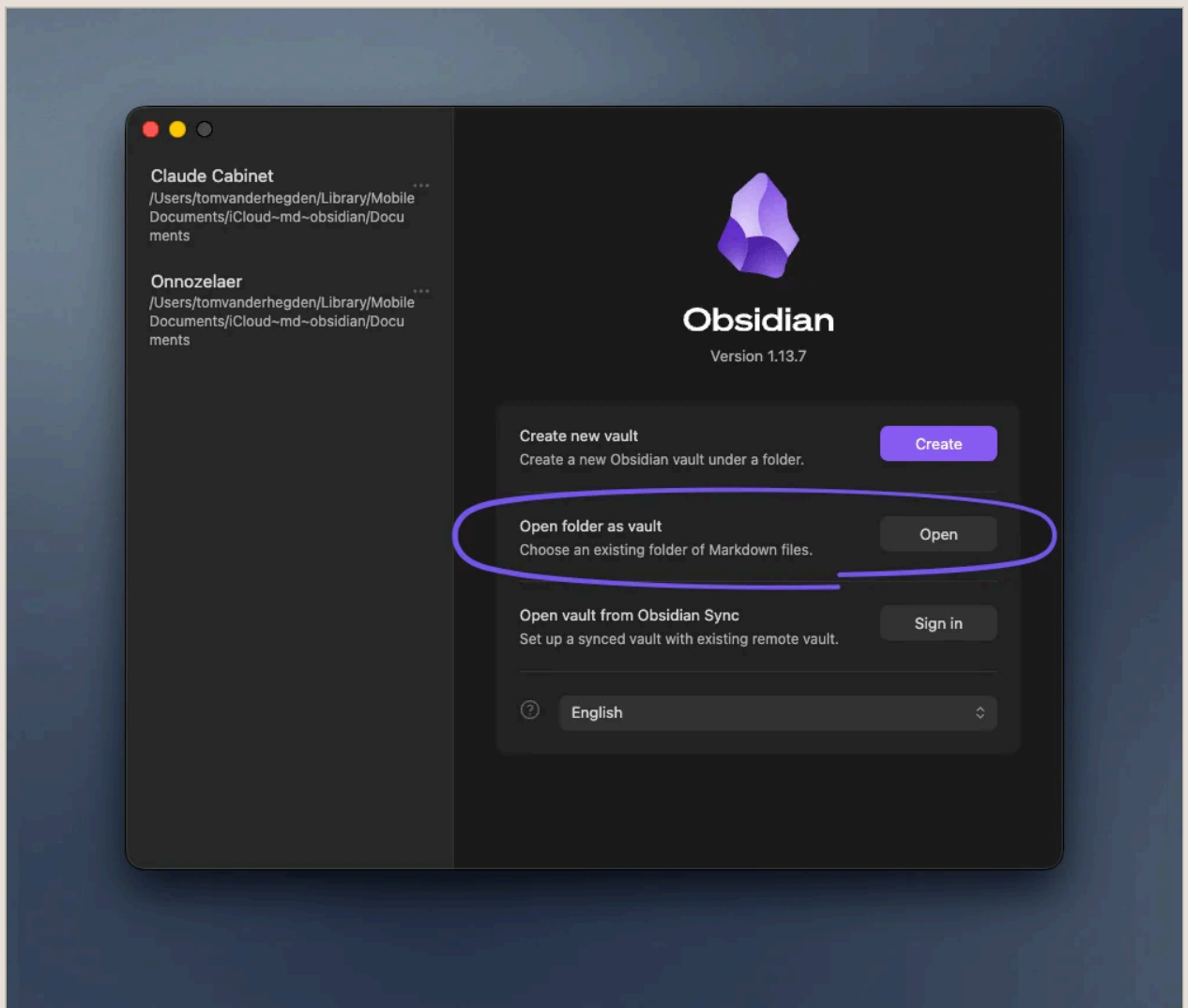
The adjutant walking you through setting up a project on `/adjutant connect`.

Open it in Obsidian

connect makes the vault folder for you. In Obsidian, choose **Open folder as vault** and pick that folder — now you can read your notes, follow the links between them, and see the board.



In Obsidian, right-click the vault name at the bottom left, then choose **Manage vaults**.



Then **Open folder as vault**, and pick the folder **connect** made for you.

Where your vault should live

Cloud-sync folder – recommended

iCloud, OneDrive, Google Drive, Dropbox. Your notes follow you across computers.

Local folder

~/Documents. Fine if you only ever use one computer.

✓ **That's it.** The record-keeping runs from here. Come back and ask **/adjutant sitrep** after a break.

The terminal, in ten commands.

The terminal is a text way to tell your computer what to do. You point it at a folder, then run a command. These ten cover almost everything a beginner needs. Type one, press Enter.

<code>pwd</code>	Show the folder you're in right now	<code>pwd</code>
<code>ls</code>	List what's in this folder	<code>ls</code>
<code>cd</code>	Go into a folder — or <code>cd ..</code> to go up one	<code>cd projects</code>
<code>mkdir</code>	Make a new folder	<code>mkdir notes</code>
<code>cp</code>	Copy a file	<code>cp a.md b.md</code>
<code>mv</code>	Move a file, or rename it	<code>mv old.md new.md</code>
<code>rm</code>	Delete a file. No undo — see <code>trash</code> below	<code>rm draft.md</code>
<code>cat</code>	Print a file to the screen	<code>cat notes.md</code>
<code>less</code>	Read a long file a page at a time — <code>q</code> quits	<code>less big.log</code>
<code>clear</code>	Wipe the screen clean	<code>clear</code>

Not sure what a command does? Run `tldr <command>` for a plain, example-first reminder (it comes with the suitcase, below).

Shortcuts, also called symlinks

A symlink is a signpost: a name in one folder that points at the real file or folder somewhere else. It is not a copy. Open the signpost and you are in the real thing. You do not need to make any of these to use adjudant, but you will meet them, and one is genuinely useful: a shortcut to your vault, sitting inside your project.

<code>ln -s</code>	Make a shortcut: real thing first, then the name you want	<code>ln -s ~/Obsidian/MyVault vault</code>
<code>ls -l</code>	Spot one: a shortcut shows an arrow to its target	<code>vault -> /Users/you/Obsidian/MyVault</code>
<code>cd</code>	Use one exactly like the real folder	<code>cd vault</code>
<code>rm</code>	Remove only the signpost . Your real folder is untouched	<code>rm vault</code>

Two things that surprise people

Deleting a shortcut never deletes what it points at, so `rm vault` is safe. But move or rename the real folder and the shortcut goes dead, pointing at nothing: make a new one. On

Windows, shortcuts work normally inside WSL. If you clone a repository with Windows' own Git instead, symlinks can arrive as small text files holding a path. That is one more reason the setup above puts you in WSL.

The suitcase: a friendlier terminal.

The bundle ships a small kit of command-line tools: the **suitcase**. It makes the terminal nicer without changing how anything works, and it is entirely optional. Everything above works without it.

This part does need a few minutes in the terminal, so it is written out in full. If that is not your idea of a good time, skip the rest of this page. Nothing breaks.

First, get the folder

The tools come from a folder you download once. You do not need git, or an account, or the command line to get it.

1 Download it

Click this link. Your browser saves a zip file, almost certainly into your **Downloads** folder: [furtive-follies.zip](#)

2 Unzip it

Double-click the file. You get a folder called **furtive-follies-master**. Leave it in Downloads, or drag it somewhere you will remember. Either is fine, as long as you can find it again in the next step.

Open a terminal inside that folder

This is the bit nobody explains. Open your **Terminal** app, type **cd** followed by one space, then **drag the folder from Finder onto the terminal window** and let go. The path types itself. Press Enter.

In your Terminal app type **cd**, a space, then drag the folder in

```
cd
```

To check you landed in the right place, run **ls**. You should see **onboarding** and **adjutant** listed. If you do not, you are in the wrong folder: try the drag again.

Then run the installer

Two commands, in that same terminal window. The first only looks and reports; it changes nothing. The second installs. Anything you already have is skipped.

In your Terminal app a dry run — shows what it would do

```
bash onboarding/onboard.sh --check
```

In your Terminal app installs the tools for real

```
bash onboarding/onboard.sh
```

What each tool does

Nothing you already know stops working. **ls**, **cd**, **rm**, **grep** and **find** stay exactly as they were.

New commands, sitting beside the old ones

z	Jump to a folder by name, from anywhere	<code>cd ../../work/app → z app</code>
ll	A rich listing: sizes, dates, git state (l and lt too)	<code>ls -lah → ll</code>
rg	Search inside files, fast	<code>grep -rn TODO . → rg TODO</code>
fd	Find files by name	<code>find . -name "*.md" → fd .md</code>
trash	Delete to the Trash, not forever. <code>rm</code> is left alone	<code>rm note.md (gone) → trash note.md</code>
glow	Read a markdown file, nicely rendered	<code>cat notes.md → glow notes.md</code>
tldr	Plain, example-first help for any command	<code>man tar → tldr tar</code>

Same command you already type, better output

cat	Now with colour and line numbers. Stays plain when piped	<code>cat app.py → cat app.py</code>
git diff	Now a clear coloured side-by-side	a wall of +/– lines → a readable diff

```

tomvanderhegden@Tom-Vs-ZenaBook-1000:~/OneDrive - zenatech.com/ZenaTech Marketing - Document Library/___Marketing...
>> ls
  _file-mounts_  = architecture_note.md      = GEMINI.md                social-scheduler-live.png
  _credentials_  = CLAUDE.md                  = generate-handoff.sh      social-submit-local.png
  _data_         = CONTRIBUTING.md            = HANDOFF.md               ss-splash.png
  _docs_         @ cover-hero-form-render.png = hs-nightly               = STATUS.md
  _import-crm_   @ cta-final.png            @ icons_preview.png       @ tsentra-modules-hs-preview.png
  _toolbox_      = DESIGN.md                  = ONBOARDING.md            @ VERSION
  _exports_      @ editor-initial.png        = PRODUCT.md               @ zs-login.png
  _hubspot-cms_  = factory_vision_note.md     @ README.md               @ zs-portrait.png
  _hubspot-crm_  @ gallery-fixed.png          @ report-top.png           @ zt.sh
  _AGENTS.md     @ gallery-top.png            @ sandro-live-abovefold.png

[ ] ~ / 0 / Z / ___Marketing Operations / ___HubSpot - Nightly  # P main #2 !3 ?4 ..... 14:56:40

```

```

tomvanderhegden@Tom-Vs-ZenaBook-1000:~/OneDrive - zenatech.com/ZenaTech Marketing - Document Library/___Marketing...
>> ll
-rw-r--r--@ 3.1k tomvanderhegden  5 Aug 16:35  = architecture_note.md
-rw-r--r--@ 3.9k tomvanderhegden 12 Aug 20:15  = CLAUDE.md
-rw-r--r--@ 6.1k tomvanderhegden 12 Aug 20:51  = CONTRIBUTING.md
-rw-r--r--@ 177k tomvanderhegden 13 Aug 04:27 -I @ cover-hero-form-render.png
-rw-r--r--@ 36k tomvanderhegden 10 Aug 12:42 -I @ cta-final.png
-rw-r--r--@ 30k tomvanderhegden 12 Aug 20:15  = DESIGN.md
-rw-r--r--@ 37k tomvanderhegden 13 Aug 04:29 -I @ editor-initial.png
-rwxr-xr-x@ 2.5k tomvanderhegden  5 Aug 10:35  = factory_vision_note.md
-rwx-----@ 141k tomvanderhegden  6 Aug 17:20 -I @ gallery-fixed.png
-rwx-----@ 128k tomvanderhegden  6 Aug 17:18 -I @ gallery-top.png
-rwxr-xr-x@ 1.3k tomvanderhegden 12 Aug 20:15  = GEMINI.md
-rwxr-xr-x@ 9.7k tomvanderhegden 11 May 16:21  = generate-handoff.sh
-rw-r--r--@ 942 tomvanderhegden 12 Aug 20:15  = HANDOFF.md
-rwxr-xr-x@ 2.8k tomvanderhegden 12 May 14:01  = hs-nightly
-rw-r--r--@ 9.3k tomvanderhegden 13 Aug 03:33 -I @ icons_preview.png
-rw-r--r--@ 4.6k tomvanderhegden 12 Aug 20:15  = ONBOARDING.md
-rw-r--r--@ 10k tomvanderhegden  5 Aug 10:35  = PRODUCT.md
-rwxr-xr-x@ 12k tomvanderhegden 12 Aug 20:15  = README.md
-rw-r--r--@ 123k tomvanderhegden 24 Jul 12:18 -I @ report-top.png
-rw-r--r--@ 347k tomvanderhegden 27 Jul 09:46 -I @ sandro-live-abovefold.png
-rw-r--r--@ 99k tomvanderhegden 30 Jul 15:26 -I @ social-scheduler-live.png
-rw-r--r--@ 84k tomvanderhegden  5 Aug 12:09 -I @ social-submit-local.png
-rw-r--r--@ 86k tomvanderhegden  5 Aug 14:31 -I @ ss-splash.png
-rwxr-xr-x@ 1.5k tomvanderhegden 12 Aug 20:15  = STATUS.md
-rw-r--r--@ 62k tomvanderhegden 27 Jul 09:44 -I @ tsentra-modules-hs-preview.png
-rwxr-xr-x@ 6 tomvanderhegden 21 May 12:31  = VERSION
-rwx-----@ 35k tomvanderhegden  6 Aug 17:24 -I @ zs-login.png
-rw-r--r--@ 112k tomvanderhegden 11 Aug 17:46 -I @ zs-portrait.png
-rwxr-xr-x@ 254 tomvanderhegden 11 May 16:21  = zt.sh

[ ] ~ / 0 / Z / ___Marketing Operations / ___HubSpot - Nightly  # P main #2 !3 ?4 ..... 14:56:56

```

The same folder twice. `ls` gives you names; `ll` adds size, date and git state, one file per line.

`sl` and `cbonsai` earn their place by adding nothing useful — a steam train and a bonsai tree, for when the terminal needs a smile.

Recommended terminal setup

Only **Zsh** is needed, and on a Mac you already have it. The other two are preference: a nicer terminal, and a prompt that tells you more.

Zsh · zsh.org

The shell these shortcuts assume. Already the default on a Mac, and on Windows inside Ubuntu. Nothing to do unless you changed it yourself.

already set up

iTerm2 · iterm2.com

A nicer terminal than the built-in one.

```
brew install --cask iterm2
```

Powerlevel10k · romkatv/powerlevel10k

A fast, informative prompt. Install it, add it to `~/.zshrc`, then run `p10k configure`.

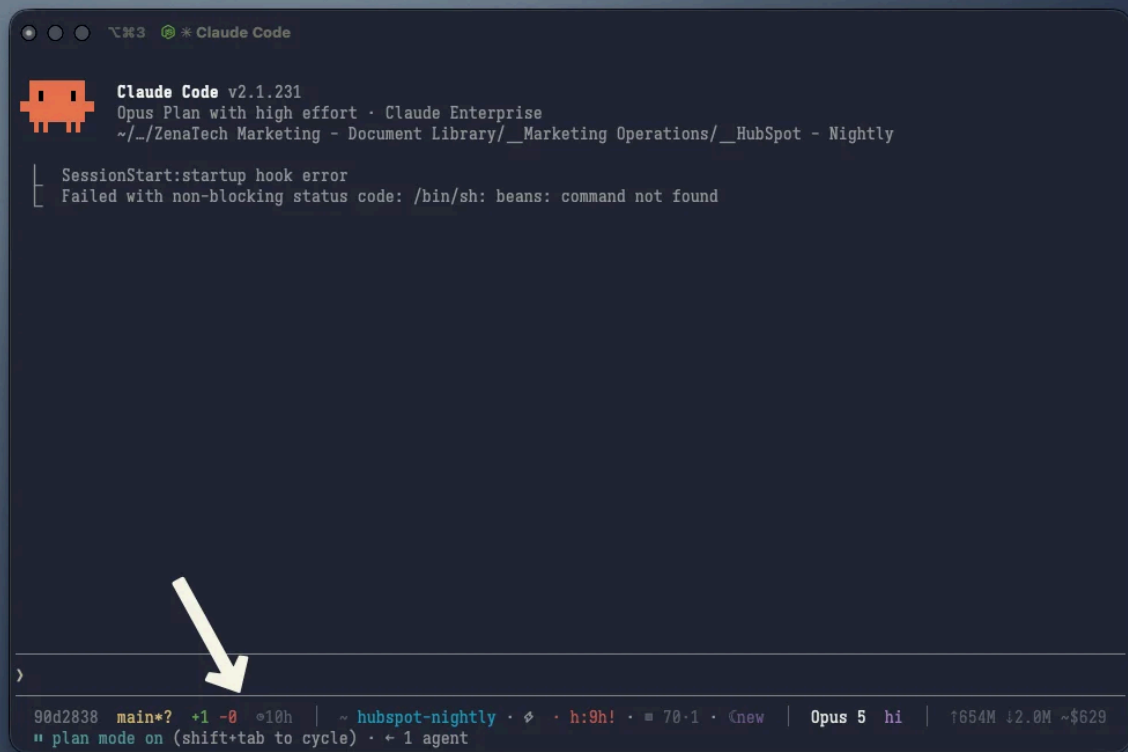
```
brew install powerlevel10k
```

Optional: a live statusline

The bundle also ships a small statusline. It shows your git branch, the vault this project is linked to, and how full the context window is — a quiet reminder to keep sessions short. Turn it on with one line in `~/.claude/settings.json`, using the real path to the script.

In `~/.claude/settings.json` turns the statusline on

```
"statusLine": { "type": "command", "command": "bash
~/Downloads/furtive-follies-master/onboarding/statusline.sh"
}
```



The statusline sits along the bottom of every session: your branch on the left, the linked vault in the middle, the model on the right.

That path assumes the folder is still in **Downloads**. If you moved it, change the path to match: in the terminal, **cd** into the folder and run **pwd** to see its full address.

On a **Windows** PC, run that same installer inside **Ubuntu** (the WSL terminal from the setup section). It sorts out the rest itself, and skips anything you already have.

If something looks off.

Vault not found

Ask **/adjutant connect** again — it re-links the project.

A write got blocked

The message names the field to fix. Adjust it, write again.

No board yet

It's born on your first task note. No tasks, no board.